SNOMED CT EXPO 2026 · LIGHTNING TALK

Data Golf 2026

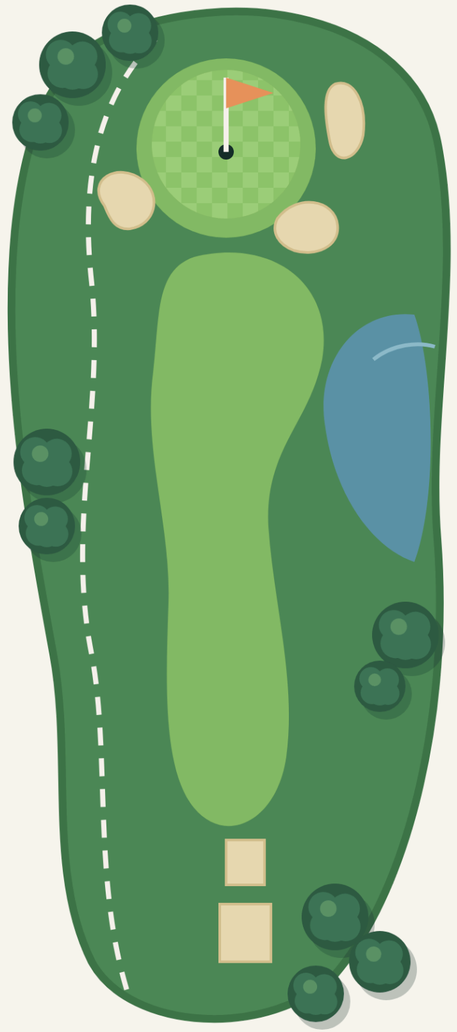
18 holes, 13 teams, one dataset: what the scorecards reveal about querying SNOMED CT over time



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Before we tee off

279,912	synthetic patient encounters, 2021 to 2026
6	SNOMED CT-AU editions; each encounter answered with the edition of its date
18	yes/no questions, scored by macro F1
13	complete submissions (15 received)
0.0024	macro F1 between the top three (0.9922, 0.9914, 0.9898); ten of 13 scored above 0.91



Most holes were par. Five decided the round.

Where the points were lost

Average F1 lost per question across the 13 complete submissions (0 = perfect)



Q1, Q2 and Q7: **every team perfect**.

Losses sit in the **two pregnancy questions**, mineral supplements, joint infection and arthritis with NSAIDs.

But the biggest **shared** mistake, on Q4, was not contested at all.

The course: 18 holes

Q1	Female as recorded sex	
Q2	BMI 30+ and cholesterol:HDL above 5	
Q3	Healthy or no current problems	
Q4	Hyperthyroidism per clinical note	
Q5	Osteoarthritis in 2024	
Q6	Taking an ACE inhibitor	
Q7	Taking a cardiac glycoside	
Q8	Fungal foot infection	
Q9	Two or more paracetamol products	
Q10	Bilateral condition	
Q11	Female 15 to 49 on methotrexate	
Q12	**Pregnant and on a teratogen**	**#1**
Q13	**OA or RA, oral NSAID, eGFR below 60**	**#5**
Q14	Upper limb wound, not fingers/thumb	
Q15	**Pregnant, fasting glucose 5.1+ mmol/L**	**#2**
Q16	**Non-Strep bacterial joint infection**	**#4**
Q17	Taking an oral iron supplement	
Q18	**Mineral supplement, not Na, K or Cl**	**#3**

Dark rows: the five holes where teams disagreed most, ranked #1 to #5.

THE SCORECARD

Par got the hard holes right, and missed the middle

Hole	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5	Q6	Q7	Q8	Q9	Q10	Q11	Q12	Q13	Q14	Q15	Q16	Q17	Q18
Par	1	2	2	4	3	3	3	3	4	4	4	6	4	3	4	3	3	5
Played	17=	16	11	5	7	13	17=	14	9	15	12	1	4	10	2	6	8	3

Q12 · par 6 · played 1st

The hardest hole, as expected: pregnancy plus a home-made teratogen list.

Q15, Q16 · played 2nd, 6th

Harder than par: pregnancy (par 4) and joint infection (par 3).

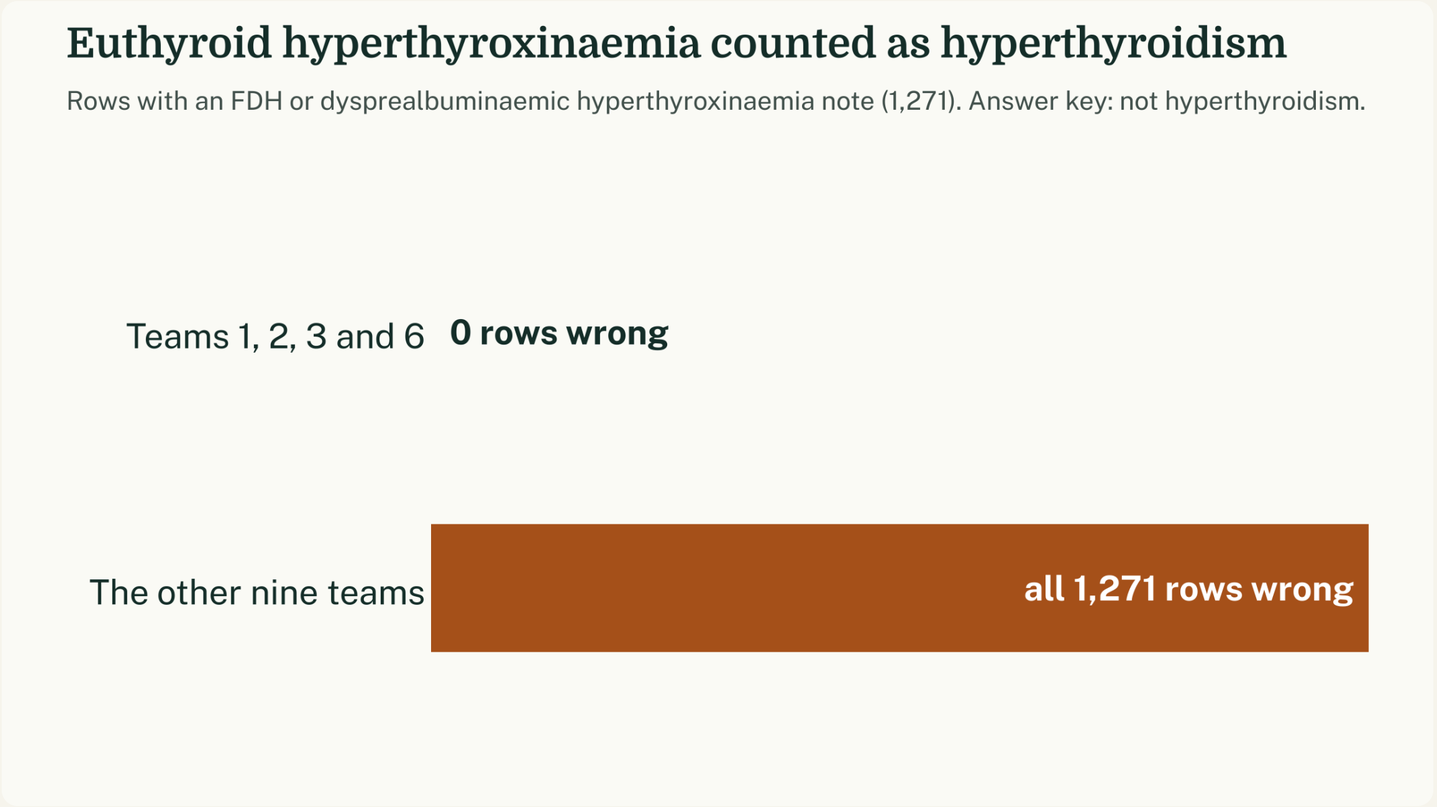
Q10, Q11 · par 4 · played 15th, 12th

Easier than par: every team scored F1 0.995 or better on Q10.

Par: organisers' rating before the event, 1 easiest to 6 hardest. Played: rank by F1 lost across 13 teams, 1 = hardest. Rank correlation 0.67.

Q4 · HYPERTHYROIDISM

The hierarchy said yes. The clinician says no.



9 of 13 teams counted familial dysalbuminaemic hyperthyroxinaemia as hyperthyroidism.

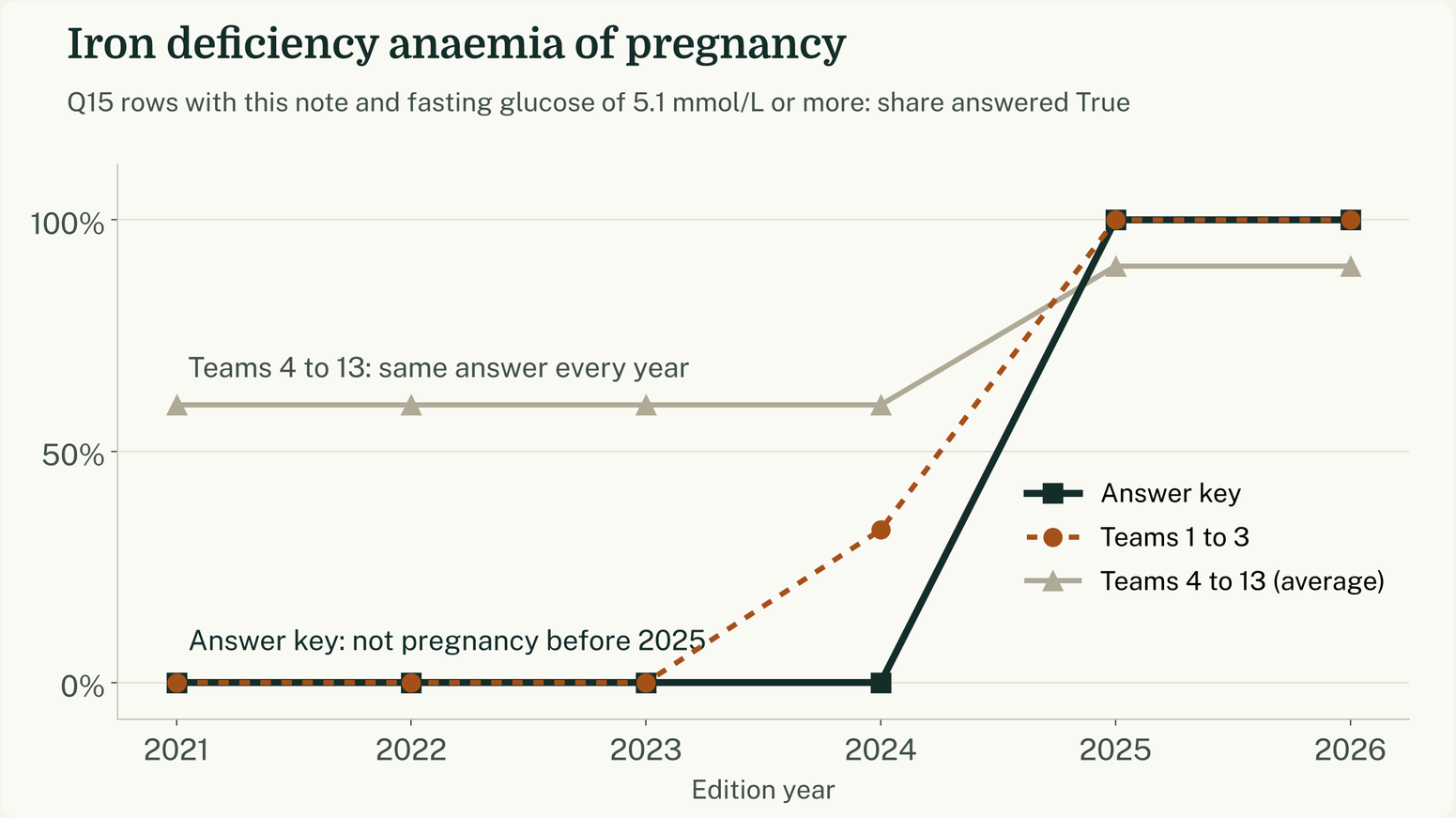
It sits under *Hyperthyroidism*, but patients are euthyroid **[1,2]**.

Seven teams gave an **identical** answer column.

[1] Pappa T, et al. Best Pract Res Clin Endocrinol Metab 2015;29:735-47. doi:10.1016/j.beem.2015.09.002
[2] Kragh-Hansen U, et al. Front Endocrinol 2017;8:297. doi:10.3389/fendo.2017.00297

Q15 · PREGNANT WITH HIGH FASTING GLUCOSE

Same concept, different right answer by year



7 concepts moved into the pregnancy grouping between editions.

Teams 1 to 3: **81 to 100%** right on those rows.

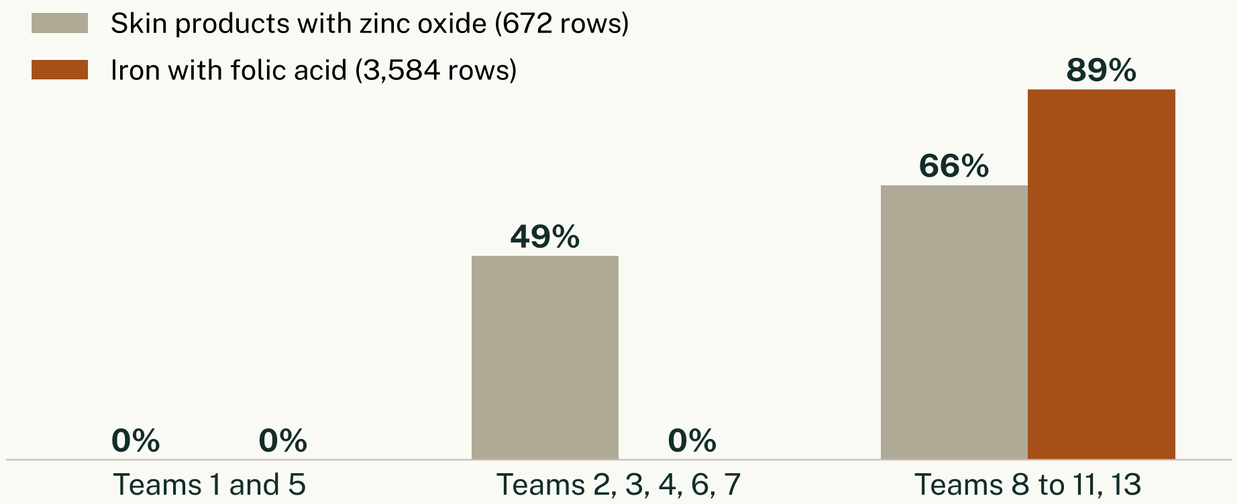
Teams 4 to 13: **42 to 74%**. Seven were no better than ignoring the year.

Q18 · MINERAL SUPPLEMENT

Asked for supplements, scored on ingredients

Which mineral products were missed

Q18: share of answer-key positives each group missed



Team 12 (not shown) missed 80% of other iron products

WHAT TEAMS DID

Zinc oxide nappy cream counts. **Five teams** dropped about half of the skin products.

Another five missed **90%** of iron with folic acid products. Two teams got everything.

WHY IT WAS HARD

The question was **silent on specific dose forms**.

373460003 |Mineral supplement| has subtypes, but **none** are used as ingredients of any product.

Participants had to research their own list. ATC A12 is a reasonable start.

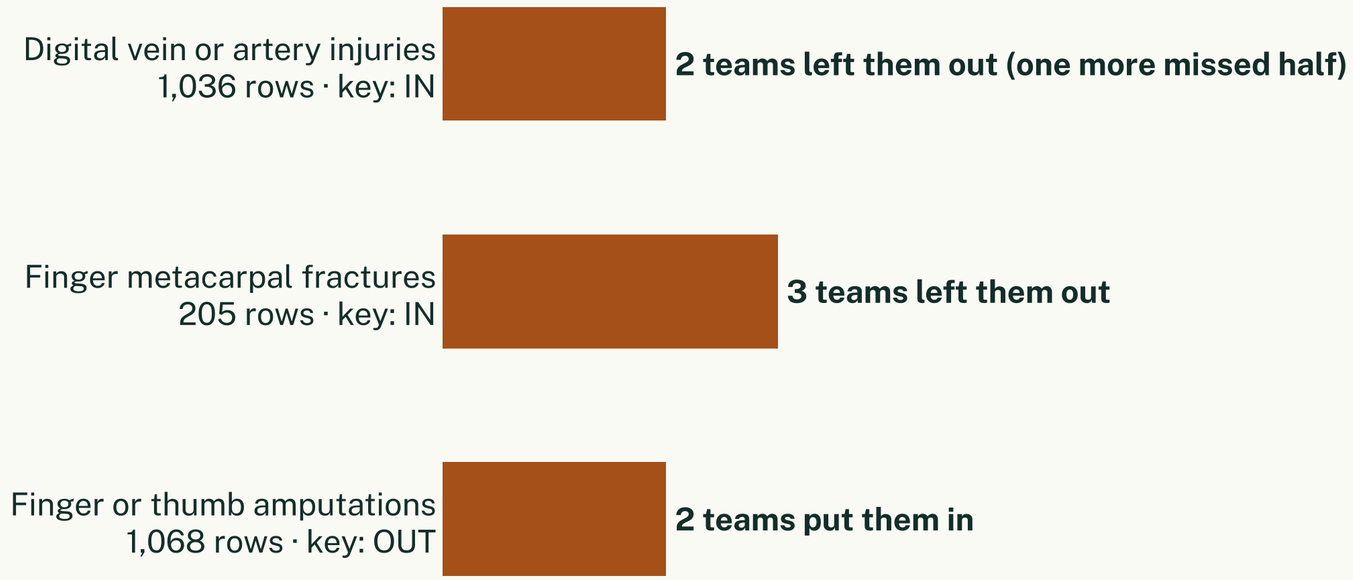
|Is modification of| links some salts to their element but not others (zinc oxide, ferrous sulfate), so **query products, not substances**.

Q14 · UPPER LIMB WOUND, NOT FINGERS OR THUMB

Words in the name are not the model

Each team tripped on a different group

Q14: teams whose answers were wrong on the whole group. Six teams were right on all three.



Digital vessel injuries and finger metacarpal fractures are **in**.

Thumb and finger amputations are **out**.

Six teams were perfect; the rest each tripped on a different group.

FOR YOUR NEXT LONGITUDINAL ANALYSIS

Five things to take back to your own data

1. **State your edition strategy.** Encounter-time and latest-edition answers differ, and neither is simply right.
2. **History supplements are not a safety net.** Q5 falls from 3,819 positives to 748 on the latest edition, even with HISTORY-MAX.
3. **Expand and read your value sets.** A descendants query inherits every editorial decision under the parent.
4. **Query attributes, not words.** Finding site, causative agent, ingredient and dose form are usually more robust than a string match.
5. **Write the definition before the ECL.** "Pregnant" and "mineral supplement" are decisions, not queries.

Thank you for playing

1ST · WINNER

Womp Ratter

Joss Markham and Dougal Fleming

0.9922 macro F1 · top of the private leaderboard

dedalus.com

2ND

Kenny-Bytes

Ken Lee

0.9914 · top of the public leaderboard

makoha.ai

3RD

Marcus Baw

0.9898 macro F1

YouTube: Everything Digital Health

State your edition strategy. Write the definition before the ECL.

Full report, with every question, chart and caveat: kaggle.com/competitions/data-golf-2026